

In acupuncture, certain points on the body associated with energy channels or meridians are stimulated by the insertion of fine needles. The belief is that these conduct vital energy or “qi” around the body. Illness or symptoms are associated with an imbalance of this vital energy.

Acupuncture has been widely and successfully used in pregnancy and regular treatments can help to treat a number of health problems:

- Pain and nausea—a recent study has shown it to be effective in relieving nausea and vomiting or the potentially more dangerous hyperemesis gravidarum (see [You are 8 weeks and 3 days](#)).
- [Heartburn](#)
- [Hemorrhoids](#)
- [Stress](#)
- Headaches and backaches
- [Carpal tunnel syndrome](#).

Acupuncture may be effective in “turning” breech babies (see [Breech baby](#)), and can also be used during labor to boost energy and relieve pain.

Use a licensed acupuncturist with experience treating pregnant women.